between Lashkar and the Haqqani Network was fueled partially by the fact that both functioned as proxies for the ISI, which at times coordinated cooperation between the two.[109]

As Lashkar's footprint grew in the NWFP and FATA, so too did the opportunity for occasional conflict with local rivals. For example, according to one former senior officer in the Intelligence Bureau, and confirmed by a high-ranking JuD official, the TTP killed approximately fifteen JuD members in Swat in 2008 and another three members in Bajaur in April 2009.[110] Both sources claimed these cadres were doing relief work, though it is possible they also were engaged in recruitment or other activities. Given the organization's missionary zeal, they almost certainly were promoting the Ahl-e-Hadith school of thought in areas where Deobandi militants were the most powerful actors. In addition to the sectarian divide, because Lashkar (and JuD) members were sometimes suspected of working with the ISI against those militants at war with the state, it is possible this contributed to the clashes.

One of the most striking examples of factional infighting occurred in the Mohmand tribal agency when the Lashkar-linked Shah Sahib group clashed with the Omar Khalid group during the summer of 2008. The latter was led by Abdul Wali Raghib [a.k.a. Omar Khalid] and operated under the TTP umbrella.[111] It fought in Afghanistan as well as against the Pakistani state and was considered more powerful than the Shah Sahib group, which abjured fighting in Pakistan.[112] The two groups managed to coexist for some time, running separate training camps and roadside checkpoints. That changed in mid July 2008 when militants from the Shah Sahib group ambushed a local TTP commander. Omar Khalid lost little time in responding, first storming Shah Sahib's shelters and later that day attacking one of its training camps. During the clash approximately ten members of the Shah Sahib group were killed and many more reportedly captured. Omar Khalid quickly had Shah Sahib and his deputy tried in a Taliban court, which ordered their executions.[113] Lashkar leaders intervened to secure their release, but despite these efforts both were killed.[114] The two outfits continued to clash for several days, while local security forces looked on passively.[115] Omar Khalid said he would release the other captives only after Lashkar's leaders assured Baitullah Mehsud that the Shah Sahib group would leave the Mohmand tribal agency. He also took